

LIKHAYA XANYWA

Site Engineer · ALEC Engineering & Contracting · United Arab Emirates
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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Site engineer delivering high-value packages on landmark UAE developments, from base-build through to client handover. Currently managing engineering delivery across four trade packages (~AED 20M combined) on RAK Central, having taken luxury guestrooms through the full fit-out lifecycle on Wynn Al Marjan. Works at the intersection of site delivery and digital information management, an ISO 19650 practitioner and Digital Workplace Champion focused on the structural and process improvements that make complex projects run faster and at lower cost. Owns scope end-to-end, coordinates multi-trade subcontractor delivery, and builds the business case for change.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Site Engineer / Package Manager | ALEC Engineering & Contracting Aug 2026 – Present

Project: RAK Central · Ras Al Khaimah, UAE

- Manage engineering delivery across **4 trade packages (~AED 20M combined value)** — BMU / façade access, waterproofing, epoxy & road markings, and ceilings & partitions.
- Own subcontractor onboarding and drive all engineering approvals — design coordination, material submittals, and method statements, to sign-off before works commence, keeping each package's mobilisation on programme.
- Coordinate subcontractor delivery day-to-day across all four packages against the master programme.

Site Engineer | ALEC Engineering & Contracting Jan – Aug 2026

Project: Wynn Al Marjan — Luxury Guestroom Fit-Out · Ras Al Khaimah, UAE

- Delivered **high-end guestrooms** through the full fit-out lifecycle — base-build to snagging to key handover to client.
- Directed a team of foremen and subcontractor labour day-to-day, sequencing multiple trades against the master programme.
- Initiated and delivered a floor-protection innovation (TAKTEC) from concept through HSE approval, site mock-up, and executive close-out, a reusable three-layer system replacing disposable covers for a **~86% cost saving (~AED 1.2M to ~AED 166K)**, recommended for rollout across future ALEC projects.
- Produced 1-month lookaheads to resequence works and recover programme after slippage.
- Raised and closed Work Inspection Requests (WIRs) and Non-Conformance Reports (NCRs) with QAQC to maintain quality standards.
- Supported the package manager on the Premier Contracting wallpaper package — subcontractor onboarding, method-statement and material-submittal review, daily manpower allocation, and progress reporting.

Junior Site Engineer | ALEC Engineering & Contracting Jan – Dec 2025

Project: Wynn Al Marjan · Ras Al Khaimah, UAE

- Supported site management and coordination for a luxury guestroom fit-out package on one of the UAE's most high-profile hospitality developments.
- Gained broad exposure across quality control, subcontractor supervision, design coordination, and HSE compliance.
- Promoted to Site Engineer within one year in recognition of performance.

Business Development Intern | Washirika 3 Oaks (W3O) Jun – Jul 2024

Cape Town, South Africa

- Supported business development within a property and construction-focused enterprise, gaining exposure to commercial operations.

Sub-Warden (H&S Portfolio) | UCT College House Residence Nov 2023 – Nov 2024

Cape Town, South Africa

- Managed the health & safety portfolio for a university residence, enforcing policy and responding to incidents.

Student Intern | Department of Public Works & Infrastructure 2022 & 2023

Queenstown, South Africa

- Gained site exposure on government construction and infrastructure projects.

EDUCATION

BSc Construction Studies | University of Cape Town Feb 2022 – Feb 2025

- Undergraduate programme covering project management, construction technology, quantity surveying, and contract administration.

National Senior Certificate | Queen's College Boys' High School 2017 – 2021

- School Prefect · Boarding House Head Boy · Interact Rotary Club President.

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- **McKinsey.org — Forward Program**: 10-week programme in structured problem-solving, communication, relationship-building, adaptability, and digital & AI essentials.
- **Operam Academy — Information Management Practitioner (ISO 19650)**: 18-module curriculum in BIM information management aligned to ISO 19650.
- **ALEC — Digital Workplace Champion**: internal champion driving adoption of Microsoft 365 tools (Teams, OneDrive) across the business.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- **The Chartered Institute of Building (CIOB)** — Member since June 2023. CIOB Tomorrow's Leaders Champion, MENA. Progressing towards Chartered Membership (MCIOB) via the Professional Development Programme.

LEADERSHIP & EXTRACURRICULAR

- **ConstructAfrica Ambassador** — pro-bono ambassador (2026–), contributing to the Education, Skills & Talent Development think tank.
- **Youth in Property Association (YIPA)** — Corporate Relations & Career Development Executive (2024).
- **UCT Sub-Warden Association** — Secretary General (2023–24).
- **UCT College House Residence** — Head Student & House Committee Member (2022–23).
- **UCT Construction Economics & Management** — 3rd-Year Class Representative (2024).

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

- **UCT Plus Gold Award (Leadership)** — for outstanding voluntary contributions across multiple leadership structures.
- **Queen's College Service Award** — for exceptional service to the school community.

References available upon request.